

SANRA Self-Rating

Scale for the Assessment of Narrative Review Articles

Every Narrative Review submitted to OSCRJ must include a completed SANRA self-rating. SANRA is a brief, validated instrument for appraising the quality of non-systematic (narrative) reviews. Score each of the six items below from 0 to 2 and report the sum (maximum 12). Authors should rate their own manuscript honestly; reviewers re-score the same six items during double-blind peer review.

OSCRSJ entry threshold: sum score ≥ 8 / 12 to enter peer review.

Manuscripts scoring below 8 are returned for improvement before review. Scoring: 0 = low standard, 1 = intermediate, 2 = high standard.

The six SANRA items

1. Justification of the article's importance for the readership

0 = not satisfied · 1 = partially · 2 = the importance is explicitly justified (e.g. burden of disease, controversy, or practical relevance to the readership).

2. Statement of concrete aims or formulation of questions

0 = not satisfied · 1 = partially · 2 = concrete aims are stated or a specific question / objective is formulated.

3. Description of the literature search

0 = not satisfied · 1 = partially · 2 = the search is described — sources searched plus search terms, time period, or inclusion/exclusion criteria.

4. Referencing

0 = not satisfied · 1 = partially · 2 = key statements are supported by appropriate, specific references; no broken or irrelevant citations.

5. Scientific reasoning (e.g. incorporation of appropriate evidence)

0 = not satisfied · 1 = partially · 2 = conclusions follow from the evidence; the relevant level of evidence is weighed rather than asserted.

6. Appropriate presentation of data

0 = not satisfied · 1 = partially · 2 = relevant endpoint data are presented appropriately (e.g. effect sizes with measures of precision).

Source & attribution

SANRA — Scale for the Assessment of Narrative Review Articles. Baethge C, Goldbeck-Wood S, Mertens S. Research Integrity and Peer Review (2019) 4:5. doi:10.1186/s41073-019-0064-8. © The Author(s) 2019. Distributed under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License (CC BY 4.0): <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>. The item titles are reproduced verbatim; the 0/1/2 anchor guidance is summarised. The authoritative anchor definitions and worked examples are in the official SANRA "explanations and instructions" document (open access via the publisher). OSCRJ reproduces the scale unmodified for self-rating and peer review.

SANRA Self-Rating — Score Sheet

Manuscript title

Manuscript ID

Date

Rated by

Role (author / reviewer / editor)

SANRA item	0	1	2
1. Justification of the article's importance for the readership	☐	☐	☐
2. Statement of concrete aims or formulation of questions	☐	☐	☐
3. Description of the literature search	☐	☐	☐
4. Referencing	☐	☐	☐
5. Scientific reasoning (e.g. incorporation of appropriate evidence)	☐	☐	☐
6. Appropriate presentation of data	☐	☐	☐
Total SANRA score (sum of items, 0–12)	≥ 8 to enter review		

Notes / justification (optional)